KUN LEE

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Tony Atkinson Fellow, LIS Cross-National Data Center; Research Associate, Luxembourg Institute of Socio-Economic Research (LISER) — 2024-Present

Research Affiliate, Department of Social Policy and Intervention (DSPI), University of Oxford, UK — 2025-Present

Visiting Researcher, Institute for Social Development and Policy Research, Seoul National University, Republic of Korea — August 2025

EDUCATION

DPhil Social Policy, University of Oxford, UK — 2020-2024

MSc Comparative Social Policy (*Distinction*), University of Oxford, UK — 2018-2019

BA Social Welfare & Economics (*Summa Cum Laude*), Seoul National University, Republic of Korea — 2012-2018

Visiting Research & Exchange

Stone Center for Inequality Dynamics, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, USA (4 months, Host: Fabian Pfeffer) — 2024

Finnish Centre for Pensions, Helsinki, Finland (1 month, Host: Kati Kuitto) — 2023

Humboldt University of Berlin Germany (3 months, Host: Anette Fasang) — 2023

University of Mannheim, Germany (4 months, Host: Bernhard Ebbinghaus) — 2022

University College London, UK (Arts & Sciences, International Exchange) — 2016-2017

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles (* Corresponding author)

Lee, K. & Ebbinghaus, B. (2025). 'Converging or unequal retirement patterns? Late working lives, retirement trajectories, and pension income in Germany over three decades of cohorts', *Social Forces*

Oh, J., Son, S. & **Lee, K.*** (2025). 'Exclusion from a 'mandatory' pension scheme: Late-stage dropouts from the National Pension System in South Korea', *Journal of the Economics of Ageing*, 100578.

Kim, K. & **Lee, K.** (2025). 'Intra-couple allocation of paid and unpaid work, allocation perceptions, and life satisfaction in South Korea: An analysis based on the 'equitable specialization' framework', *Korean Journal of Social Welfare*, 77(2), 213-237 [in Korean]

Lee, K. (2024). 'Varying Effects of Public Pensions: Pension Spending and Old-age Employment under Different Pension Regimes.' *Journal of European Social Policy*, 34(1).

- JESP/ESPAnet Doctoral Researcher Prize 2023 (Best Paper)
- SASE 2023 Early Career Workshop Award

Lee, K. (2022). 'Old-age Poverty in a Pension Latecomer: The Impact of Basic Pension Expansions in South Korea', *Social Policy & Administration*, 56(7), 1022-1040.

Lee, K. & Zaidi, A. (2020). 'How policy configurations matter: a critical look into pro-natal policy in South Korea based on a gender and family framework', *International Journal of Sociology & Social Policy*, 40(7/8), 589-606.

Book Chapters

Kuitto, K. & **Lee, K.** (2025). 'How to make extending working lives in ageing welfare states socially sustainable', in M. Vaalavuo, K. Nelson & K. Kuitto (eds.), *Social Sustainability in Ageing Welfare States*, Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar.

Ebbinghaus, B. & **Lee, K.** (2023). 'From early retirement to later exit from work: shifting towards active ageing', in D. Clegg & N. Durazzi (eds.), *Handbook of Labour Market Policy in Advanced Democracies*, Cheltenham, UK: Edward Elgar.

Selected Working Papers

Old and new welfare states retaining older workers in the face of crisis: The case of COVID-19 in Europe (single author; Revise & Resubmit, *Socio-Economic Review*).

Context matters: The role of family policies shaping fertility and women's labor force participation across policy regimes (with Eunho Cha & Stacie Tao; *under review*)

Welfare states and wealth inequality: Pension systems, the public-private mix, and augmented wealth in old age (with Javier Olivera & Philippe Van Kerm)

Threats of AI? Workers' perceptions of technological change and precautionary savings behaviour (with Ludivine Martin & Thuc-Uyen Nguyen-Thi; *under review*)

A fragile social contract: The politics of an unpopular pension reform in South Korea (with Dong-kyun Im)

Still Beveridge or Bismarck? Revising the typology of pension systems for the 21st century (with Bernhard Ebbinghaus and Daria Frost, *under review*)

AWARDS, GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

Social Policy Association Travel Grant (EASP-SPA Joint Annual Conference)	2025
KFAS-Salzburg Global Fellowship	2024
SustAgeable Consortium Project Grant, Helsinki, Finland	2023
Horowitz Foundation for Social Policy Doctoral Dissertation Grant	2023
JESP/ESPAnet Doctoral Researcher Prize (Best Paper)	2023
SASE Early Career Workshop Award	2023
German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) Short-term Research Grant	2022
ICPSR Summar Program Scholarship for Public Administration, Public Policy, and	2022

Public Affairs, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI, USA

Centenary Scholarship, DSPI, University of Oxford, UK	2020
Korea Foundation for Advanced Studies (KFAS) Doctoral Fellowship	2020
Republic of Korea Government Scholarship for Study Overseas	2018

TEACHING

University of Oxford, Oxford, UK

Social Policy (Undergraduate) – *Seminar Leader*	Fall 2023; 2021-2022
Quantitative Analysis (Postgraduate) – *Teaching Assistant*	Fall 2023
Training for Advanced Teaching & Learning, Higher Education Academy (UK Professional Standards Framework)	Winter/Spring 2022

University of Mannheim, Mannheim, Germany

Reform Dynamics in European Welfare States (Undergraduate) – *Co-Instructor* (with Bernhard Ebbinghaus)	Spring 2023

INVITED LECTURES

'Panel Data Analysis using LIS data', *LIS Summer Workshop*, Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxembourg, 2 July 2025 & July 2026 (scheduled)

'Analyzing Panel Data in Comparative Research', Guest lectures

- *Governance and Global Affairs Methods Lab*, Leiden University the Hauge, Netherlands, 19 February 2026
- *Comparative Research Methods*, University of Mannheim, Germany, November 2022

'The Luxembourg Income and Wealth Study: Introduction and Applications to Comparative Inequality Research', Special Lecture at the Annual Symposium of the *Korean Inequality Research Network*, Seoul, Korea, 16 July 2025

'Introduction to the South Korean Pension System: History, Current State and Challenges', *ETK Research Seminar*, Finnish Centre for Pensions, Helsinki, 4 October 2023

SEMINARS/WORKSHOPS

'The politics of an unpopular pension reform: Evidence from two survey experiments in South Korea', *Policy & Politics Workshop*, Leiden University, Netherlands, 26 March 2026

'Still Beveridge or Bismarck? Revising the typology of pension systems for the 21st Century', *European Symposium on Policy Modelling*, Luxembourg, 25 March 2026'

'Welfare states and wealth inequality: Pension systems, the public-private mix, and augmented wealth in old age'

- *ETK Pension Research Forum*, Finnish Centre for Pensions, 16 March 2026
- *(LIS)^{2}ER-SHARE Workshop: Pensions and Old-age Well-being*, 27-28 November 2025
- *CBS Seminar*, Herman Deleeck Centre for Social Policy, University of Antwerp, 15 May 2025

'Threats of AI? How workers perceive and respond to technological change in the workplace'

- *East Asian Political Economy Workshop*, King's College London, 26 June 2025
- *Netspar International Pension Workshop,* Leiden, 18 June 2025

'Convergence or continued stratification? Late working lives, retirement trajectories, and pension income in Germany'

- *Sequence Analysis Association* Webinar Series, 17 October 2024 (online)
- *LISER Seminar Series*, Luxembourg, 7 November 2024

'Socio-demographic differences in older workers' job loss in the early phase of the pandemic', *ESPAnet Germany PhD Workshop*, WZB Berlin, 16-17 March 2023

'The Impact of Basic Pension Expansions on Older People's Income and Poverty in South Korea', *BSA Social Statistics Group* Brown Bag (online), 30 September 2021

CONFERENCE PRESENATIONS (* Poster)

World Inequality Conference (scheduled); PAA Annual Meeting (scheduled); In_equality Conference; Winter School on Inequality and Social Welfare Theory	2026
ISI Wealth Inequality Conference; Research on East Asian Demography & Inequality Meeting; SPA Annual Conference; PAA Annual Meeting; ISA-RC28 Spring Meeting; Comparative Economic Inequality Conference	2025
Annual ESPAnet Conference; EASP-FISS Joint Conference; PAA Annual Meeting*	2024
Annual ESPAnet Conference; ISA-RC28 Summer Meeting*; SASE Annual Conference; SPA Annual Conference; ISA-RC28 Spring Meeting	2023
ESA-RN26 Conference; Annual ESPAnet Conference; FISS Annual Conference	2022
Annual ESPAnet Conference; BSA Work, Employment & Society Meeting; EASP-FISS Joint Annual Conference	2021
East Asian Social Policy Annual Conference	2019

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Journal Referee Service: Ageing & Society, Applied Economics, Asian Social Work & Policy Review, International Journal of Social Welfare, International Journal of Sociology & Social Policy, Humanities & Social Science Communications, Journal of Aging & Social Policy, Journal of Asian Public Policy, Journal of Economic Inequality, Journal of the Economics of Ageing, Journal of Governmental Studies, Nature Scientific Data, Poverty & Public Policy, Social Policy & Administration, Social Science Research, Socius

Core Member, Pensions Policy Research Group, Social Policy Association UK, 2023-Present

Organizing Committee, $(LIS)^2$ER-SHARE Luxembourg Joint Workshop: "Pensions and Old-age Well-being: Policy Challenges in Ageing Societies", 27-28 November 2025

Organizing Committee, 5th $(LIS)^2$ER Workshop: "Fighting Poverty: Measurement and Policy Challenges", 11-13 December 2024

Organizing Committee, Symposium for Early Researchers in Social Policy & Intervention, Nuffield College, Oxford, 27 May 2022

Co-chair, Young Scholar Session: Labour market and social policy responses to the pandemic, The COVID-19 Public Health and Social Measures (PHSMs) Conference, 6 October 2021

ENGAGEMENT ACTIVITIES

'How pension systems (re)shape the landscape of wealth inequality and redistribution', *LIS Newsletter*, March 2026

2nd KFAS-Salzburg Global Leadership Initiative: Technology, Growth & Inequality, 2024-25

Contributions to Oxford Supertracker: A global database for COVID-19 policy trackers

Organizing Committee, Oxford-Korea Forum, Wolfson College, Oxford, 12 November 2021

'Myths and Truths of the South Korean National Pension', *Oxford Korean Academic Society* Public Lecture Series, 1 December 2023

'Changes in European Countries', in Sang-jin Han (ed.), *An International Comparative Study on Citizen Participatory Governance Model and Health and Welfare Policies in the COVID-19 Era*, Policy Report for the Ministry of Health and Welfare, Republic of Korea

'Europe's Policy Responses to the Labour Market Crisis during the Pandemic', *Oxford Korean Academic Society* Public Lecture Series, 21 October 2021

Treasurer, Oxford Korean Academic Society, University of Oxford, 2020-21

RESEARCH & WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, University of Oxford, UK	2021
Research Assistant, Seoul National University, Korea	2021
Research Assistant, King's College London, UK	2020
Administrative Assistant, Seoul National University, Korea	2019-2020
IARU Global Intern, Oxford Institute of Population Ageing, Oxford, UK	2019
Social Work Trainee, Hanwoori Rehabilitation Center, Seoul, Korea	2018
Military Service, National Assembly Police Officer, Seoul, Korea	2014-2015

OTHER SKILLS

Languages: English (fluent), Korean (native)

Statistical Software: R, Stata

REFERENCES

Bernhard Ebbinghaus
Professor & Chair of Macrosociology
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Relationship: PhD Supervisor

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